

COLLAPSE

1. Passage anchor

> “He told me that one night, during a typhoon, his father suddenly ****collapsed at home****.”

Passage meaning

****collapse**** = suddenly fall down because of illness, weakness, injury, exhaustion, etc.

****突然倒下；癱倒；昏倒****

Here, Kelvin’s father suddenly lost physical strength and fell down during a medical emergency.

Important:

****collapse**** does ****not necessarily mean become unconscious****.

A person can collapse while still conscious.

Practice

1. He suddenly ****collapsed**** and fell to the floor.

他突然****倒下****，跌在地上。

2. She ****collapsed from exhaustion**** after working all night.

她通宵工作後因筋疲力盡而****癱倒****。

Core meanings of COLLAPSE

2. collapse — person suddenly fall down

= suddenly fall to the ground because one becomes weak, ill, injured, exhausted, etc.

****突然倒下；癱倒****

Examples

1. The runner ****collapsed**** near the finish line.

那名跑手在終點附近突然****倒下****。

2. He ****collapsed**** shortly after arriving home.

他回家不久後便突然****倒下****。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. collapse from exhaustion / heat / weakness

= fall down because one's body can no longer continue functioning normally

因疲勞 / 炎熱 / 虛弱而倒下

Examples

1. She nearly **collapsed from exhaustion**.
她幾乎因筋疲力盡而**倒下**。
2. One participant **collapsed from the heat**.
一名參加者因炎熱而**倒下**。

4. collapse into a chair / bed

= drop heavily into a chair, bed, etc. because of tiredness, weakness, relief, etc.

一屁股癱坐 / 倒在.....上

Examples

1. He **collapsed into a chair** after the long journey.
長途旅程後，他**癱坐在椅子上**。
2. She got home and **collapsed onto the bed**.
她回到家後便**癱倒在床上**。

This often does **not** imply a medical emergency.

Building / physical structure

5. collapse — building or structure falls down

= suddenly fall inward or downward because support fails

倒塌；坍塌；塌下

Examples

1. The roof **collapsed** during the storm.
屋頂在暴風雨期間**倒塌**了。

2. Part of the bridge ****collapsed****.

大橋有一部分****坍塌****。

Major literal sense.

6. collapse under weight / pressure

= give way because something cannot support a load or force

****因重量 / 壓力而塌下****

Examples

1. The shelf ****collapsed under the weight**** of the books.

架子承受不住書本的重量而****塌下****。

2. The structure ****collapsed under pressure****.

那個結構在壓力下****倒塌****。

Noun: physical collapse

7. collapse — falling down of a structure

= sudden failure and falling of a building, structure, etc.

****倒塌 ; 坍塌****

Examples

1. Investigators examined the cause of the building's ****collapse****.

調查人員研究大樓****倒塌****的原因。

2. The bridge ****collapse**** blocked the road.

大橋****坍塌****導致道路受阻。

Organization / system failure

8. collapse — stop functioning successfully

= fail suddenly or completely as an organization, system, arrangement, etc.

****崩潰 ; 瓦解 ; 失效****

Examples

1. The entire system **collapsed**.
整個系統**崩潰了**。
2. The organization **collapsed** after losing its funding.
該組織失去資金後**瓦解了**。

Major figurative extension.

9. collapse of a system / organization

= complete or severe failure of a functioning system or institution
系統 / 組織崩潰；瓦解

Examples

1. The war caused the **collapse of public services**.
戰爭導致公共服務**崩潰**。
2. The company's sudden **collapse** surprised employees.
公司的突然**倒閉 / 崩潰**令員工感到意外。

Business / company

10. company collapses

= company fails financially and can no longer operate
公司倒閉；企業垮台

Examples

1. Several businesses **collapsed** during the downturn.
經濟低迷期間，有幾家公司**倒閉**。
2. The firm **collapsed** under heavy debt.
那家公司因債務沉重而**垮掉**。

Economy

11. economic collapse

= severe breakdown of an economy

****經濟崩潰****

Examples

1. The country faced ****economic collapse****.
該國面臨****經濟崩潰****。
2. Years of instability led to the ****collapse of the economy****.
多年不穩定導致經濟****崩潰****。

Market / price

12. collapse — price or market falls dramatically

= decrease extremely sharply in value, price, demand, etc.

****暴跌；崩跌****

Examples

1. Oil prices ****collapsed****.
油價****暴跌****。
2. The market ****collapsed**** after the announcement.
公告發布後市場****崩跌****。

13. market collapse / price collapse

= sudden dramatic fall in market activity, prices, or value

****市場崩盤；價格暴跌****

Examples

1. Investors feared a ****market collapse****.
投資者擔心出現****市場崩盤****。
2. A sudden ****price collapse**** hurt producers.
價格突然****暴跌****令生產商受損。

Agreement / negotiation / plan failure

14. talks / negotiations collapse

= discussions fail completely and stop

談判破裂；協商失敗

Examples

1. The negotiations **collapsed** after several days.

幾天後談判**破裂**。

2. Peace talks **collapsed** without an agreement.

和談在沒有達成協議的情況下**破裂**。

15. deal / agreement collapses

= proposed agreement fails and will no longer happen

交易 / 協議告吹；破裂

Examples

1. The deal **collapsed** at the last minute.

這筆交易在最後一刻**告吹**。

2. Their agreement **collapsed** over money.

他們的協議因金錢問題而**破裂**。

Government / regime / political structure

16. government / regime collapses

= loses the ability or authority to continue functioning

政府 / 政權垮台；瓦解

Examples

1. The government **collapsed** after losing support.

政府失去支持後**垮台**。

2. The old regime eventually **collapsed**.

舊政權最終**瓦解**。

Emotional / psychological breakdown

17. collapse emotionally

= suddenly become unable to cope emotionally

情緒崩潰

Examples

1. After months of pressure, he finally **collapsed emotionally**.

承受數月壓力後，他終於**情緒崩潰**。

2. She almost **collapsed under the stress**.

她幾乎因壓力而**撐不住**。

Here, the meaning is figurative unless physical falling is also implied.

18. collapse in tears

= suddenly begin crying intensely, often because of overwhelming emotion

突然哭倒 / 情緒崩潰大哭

Examples

1. She **collapsed in tears** after hearing the news.

她聽到消息後**情緒崩潰，痛哭起來**。

2. He **collapsed in tears** when the pressure became too much.

壓力變得難以承受時，他**崩潰大哭**。

Fold / flatten a structure

19. collapse — fold something into a smaller form

= fold or cause something to fold down so that it occupies less space

折疊；收合；縮合

Examples

1. The table **collapses** for easy storage.

這張桌子可以**折疊收起**，方便存放。

2. The frame can be **collapsed** when not in use.

框架不用時可以**收合**。

Distinct practical sense.

20. collapsible

= designed so that it can be folded into a smaller shape

可折疊的；可收合的

Examples

1. We bought a **collapsible chair**.

我們買了一張**可折疊椅**。

2. The bottle is **collapsible** for easy storage.

這個瓶子可以**壓縮收合**，方便收藏。

High-value family form.

Digital / user interface

21. collapse — hide the contents of an expanded section

= reduce an expanded menu, section, tree, panel, etc. so that its details are no longer displayed

收合；摺疊；隱藏展開內容

Examples

1. Click the arrow to **collapse the menu**.

點擊箭頭即可**收合選單**。

2. You can **collapse this section** to save space.

你可以**收合這一部分**以節省畫面空間。

Very common modern computing/UI sense.

22. collapsed section / menu

= section whose detailed contents have been hidden

****已收合的區段 / 選單****

Examples

1. The details are inside the ****collapsed section****.

詳細資料位於****已收合的區段****內。

2. Tap the heading to reopen the ****collapsed menu****.

點擊標題即可重新打開****已收合選單****。

Data / categories

23. collapse — combine multiple categories or levels into fewer ones

Technical/academic:

= merge several distinctions, categories, values, etc. into a smaller number

****合併；歸併****

Examples

1. The researchers ****collapsed the categories**** into three groups.

研究人員把這些類別****合併成三組****。

2. Several response options were ****collapsed into one category****.

幾個回應選項被****歸併為一類****。

Useful in data analysis, though lower priority than the everyday senses.

Science / physics

24. collapse — contract inward under force

= shrink inward or become much smaller because of pressure, gravity, etc.

****向內塌縮；收縮****

Examples

1. The cavity **collapsed** under external pressure.

空腔在外部壓力下**向內塌縮**。

2. The star eventually **collapsed** under its own gravity.

恆星最終在自身重力作用下**塌縮**。

25. gravitational collapse

= contraction of an astronomical object under its own gravity

重力塌縮

Examples

1. A massive star may undergo **gravitational collapse**.

大質量恆星可能經歷**重力塌縮**。

2. The process begins with **gravitational collapse**.

這個過程由**重力塌縮**開始。

Established scientific use.

Mathematical / technical simplification

26. collapse to / into

= reduce suddenly or completely to a simpler state, value, structure, etc.

縮減為；歸結為

Examples

1. Under these conditions, the expression **collapses to** a much simpler form.

在這些條件下，這個算式會**簡化為**更簡單的形式。

2. Several possibilities **collapse into** a single outcome.

幾種可能性**歸結為**一個結果。

Lower-priority technical extension.

COLLAPSED

27. collapsed — fallen down

= having fallen or caved in

已倒塌的；坍塌的

Examples

1. Rescue workers searched the **collapsed building**.
救援人員搜索**倒塌的建築物**。
2. The road was blocked by a **collapsed wall**.
道路被一堵**倒塌的牆**阻塞。

28. collapsed — folded / compressed

= folded or reduced into a smaller form

已折疊的；已收合的

Examples

1. Store the chair in its **collapsed form**.
把椅子以**收合狀態**存放。
2. The menu is currently **collapsed**.
選單目前處於**收合狀態**。

COLLAPSING

29. collapsing — failing / falling

= in the process of falling, failing, or breaking down

正在倒塌的；正在崩潰的

Examples

1. They escaped from the **collapsing building**.
他們逃離了那棟**正在倒塌的建築物**。
2. The government struggled to stabilize the **collapsing economy**.
政府努力穩定**正在崩潰的經濟**。

High-value constructions

30. collapse under the pressure

A. physical

= fail structurally because of physical pressure

****在壓力下塌陷****

B. figurative

= become unable to cope because of stress or demands

****承受不住壓力而崩潰****

Examples

1. The roof ****collapsed under the pressure**** of the snow.
屋頂承受不住積雪壓力而****塌下****。
2. He eventually ****collapsed under the pressure**** of the job.
他最終承受不住工作壓力而****崩潰****。

31. collapse under one's own weight

= fall because one's own weight can no longer be supported

****因自身重量而倒塌****

Examples

1. The old structure ****collapsed under its own weight****.
舊結構因承受不住****自身重量而倒塌****。
2. Part of the roof ****collapsed under its own weight****.
屋頂的一部分因****自身重量****而塌下。

Key contrasts

32. collapse vs fall

****fall****

= move downward accidentally or naturally

****跌下；倒下****

****collapse****

= fall suddenly because support, strength, or functioning fails

****突然倒下；坍塌****

Compare:

> He fell on the stairs.

> 他在樓梯上跌倒。

> He collapsed because he became suddenly ill.

> 他因突然不適而倒下。

33. collapse vs faint

****faint****

= briefly lose consciousness because not enough blood/oxygen is reaching the brain

****暈倒；昏厥****

****collapse****

= suddenly fall because of weakness, illness, injury, exhaustion, etc.; unconsciousness is ****not required****

****突然倒下****

So:

> Someone may ****collapse without fainting****.

This distinction is particularly important in the passage.

34. collapse vs pass out

****pass out****

= informal: lose consciousness

****昏倒；失去知覺****

****collapse****

= fall down or lose physical strength; may remain conscious

Therefore:

> He collapsed.
> → 他突然倒下。

does ****not automatically mean****:

> He passed out.
> → 他失去了知覺。

35. collapse vs crumble

****crumble****
= break into small pieces or gradually fall apart
****碎裂；崩碎****

****collapse****
= structure loses support and falls down/inward
****倒塌；坍塌****

A wall may ****crumble****, while an entire building may ****collapse****.

36. collapse vs crash

****crash****
= collide violently, or fail suddenly in some technical/economic contexts
****撞毀；當機；暴跌****

****collapse****
= broader idea of losing support, structure, strength, or functioning
****崩潰；倒塌****

Compare:

> computer crashed
> 電腦當機

> system collapsed
> 系統全面崩潰

37. collapse vs fail

****fail****

= not succeed or stop working properly

****失敗；故障****

****collapse****

= fail severely, suddenly, or completely, often with the image of something losing its structure

****崩潰；瓦解****

38. collapse vs fold — physical object

****fold****

= bend one part over another

****摺疊****

****collapse****

= cause an entire structure to fold down or shrink into a compact form

****收合****

Compare:

> fold a piece of paper

> 把紙摺起來

> collapse a camping chair

> 把露營椅收合

Meaning map

The central concept of ****collapse**** is:

****lose the support or strength needed to remain upright or functioning****

From this develop several major branches.

A. Person

Passage

father collapsed

→ ****父親突然倒下****

Exhaustion

collapse from exhaustion

→ **筋疲力盡而癱倒**

B. Structure

Building

building collapses

→ **建築物倒塌**

Weight

collapse under weight

→ **承受不住重量而塌下**

C. Systems

Organization

company collapses

→ **公司倒閉**

Economy

economy collapses

→ **經濟崩潰**

Market

prices collapse

→ **價格暴跌**

Negotiation

talks collapse

→ **談判破裂**

D. Compacting

Furniture

table collapses

→ **桌子可以折疊收合**

Interface

collapse a menu

→ **收合選單**

E. Science

Physical contraction

star collapses

→ **恆星塌縮**

The shared idea remains remarkably consistent:

something loses the strength, support, or expanded structure that was holding it up.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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collapse — person	因疾病、虛弱、受傷、疲勞等突然倒下 / 癱倒
collapse from exhaustion/heat	因極度疲勞、炎熱等而身體支撐不住並倒下
collapse into a chair/bed	因疲累等而一下子癱坐 / 倒在椅子或床上
collapse — structure	建築、屋頂、橋等失去支撐而倒塌 / 坍塌
collapse under weight/pressure	因無法承受重量或壓力而塌下
collapse — noun physical	建築或結構突然倒塌 / 坍塌
collapse — system/organization	系統、組織等完全失效、崩潰或瓦解
company collapse	公司因財務等問題而倒閉 / 垮台
economic collapse	經濟體系嚴重失效；經濟崩潰
market/price collapse	市場或價格突然大幅下跌；崩盤 / 暴跌
talks/negotiations collapse	談判完全失敗並停止；談判破裂
deal/agreement collapses	交易、協議等失敗告吹
government/regime collapses	政府 / 政權失去運作能力而垮台 / 瓦解
collapse emotionally	因壓力或情緒無法承受而崩潰
collapse in tears	突然情緒崩潰並大哭
collapse — fold down	把結構折疊 / 收合成較小形態
collapsible	可以折疊、收合以方便存放的

collapse — UI	把已展開的選單、區段等收合並隱藏細節	
collapsed menu/section	詳細內容已被收起的選單 / 區段	
collapse categories	把多個類別合併 / 歸併成較少類別	
collapse — physical contraction	因壓力、重力等向內塌縮 / 收縮	
gravitational collapse	天體在自身重力作用下發生的重力塌縮	
collapse to/into	技術語境：縮減 / 歸結為較簡單狀態或結果	
collapsed — fallen	已經倒塌 / 坍塌的	
collapsed — folded	已折疊 / 收合的	
collapse under pressure — figurative	因心理、工作等壓力太大而撐不住 / 崩潰	

Passage recap

> “He told me that one night, during a typhoon, his father suddenly **collapsed at home**.”

Here:

collapse = **to suddenly lose physical strength and fall down because something is medically or physically wrong**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **突然倒下**

* **癱倒**

* depending on confirmed context, possibly **昏倒**

Natural contextual translation:

他告訴我，去年有一晚颱風期間，他父親突然在家中倒下。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

collapse

= **to suddenly fall down because of illness, weakness, injury, exhaustion, etc.**

突然倒下；癱倒

The most important learner distinction is:

> **collapse**

> → 身體突然支撐不住而倒下

but:

> **faint / pass out**

> → ****失去知覺****

Therefore the passage itself does ****not**** prove that Kelvin's father became unconscious.

The wider family then branches naturally:

> ****building collapses****

> → **建築物**倒塌****

> ****company collapses****

> → **公司**倒閉****

> ****economy collapses****

> → **經濟**崩潰****

> ****prices collapse****

> → **價格**暴跌****

> ****negotiations collapse****

> → **談判**破裂****

> ****collapse a menu****

> → ****收合選單****

> ****collapsible chair****

> → ****可折疊椅****

So the passage uses the ****human physical failure / sudden fall**** branch of a word whose underlying idea is consistently ****losing the support or strength needed to remain upright, expanded, or functioning****.